The Roman Empire

Out of all the civilizations to emerge in the western world, the Roman Empire is often said to be the most widespread political and social empire. At its peak around 117 CE, it spread across much of modern day Europe, North Africa and parts of the Middle East. By the late third century, it had spread itself far too thin to be ruled from Rome and was divided into Western and Eastern divisions with a co-ruler leading each section. The civilization is known as the Roman Empire from 31 BCE onwards because Octavian renamed himself Augustus Caesar as the first emperor of Rome. Prior to Augustus, it was known as the Roman Republic when the Senate was in power. After Romulus Augustulus fell from power in 476 AD, the Roman Empire carried on in the East as the Byzantine Empire until the Ottomans eventually conquered it centuries later. The Roman Empire left its mark on history by influencing every part of education, language, religion and culture.